I managed to score 133 from 59 balls, and we set what proved a winning total of 235 for one.

We finished third in what was a congested final league, level with two other teams on 16 points, and progressed to play Rajasthan Royals in the eliminator, a match we won by 71 runs in Pune after I made 66 from 38 balls, helping the team set what proved to be a winning total of 180 for four.

After all the frustration, it felt as if we were finally finding form and consistency at the right time, at the business end of the tournament, but two days later we were beaten by CSK in a low-scoring second qualifier, a semifinal, after we struggled to score 139 and they reached the target with one ball to spare.

Bengaluru, formerly known as Bangalore, is known as the 'Garden City' on account of its green spaces and parks, and I have grown very fond of both the city and its people. There is a particular energy on the streets that is hard to explain and wonderful to experience and, every time I return, it feels as if ongoing development has further enhanced the infrastructure ... as far as I can tell from the team bus.

In truth, it's almost impossible for any relatively well-known cricketer to walk around the city because they would very soon be submerged by cricket supporters. Just leaving the team hotel requires significant logistical planning: not long ago, I visited Red Monster, producers of a video game that I have endorsed, at their offices in Bengaluru, and they had to hire four security guards to help me get in and out of the building.

The daily life of an IPL cricketer is almost completely contained within an air-conditioned cycle of five-star hotels, team buses, stadiums, airplanes and airports, and almost the only place we ever meet real supporters tends to be in the controlled and sterilised environment of one or other marbled hotel foyer.

In the early years of my career, supporters wanted nothing more than your autograph, but times have changed and cricketers don't have to